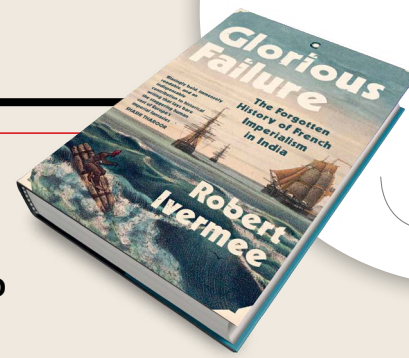
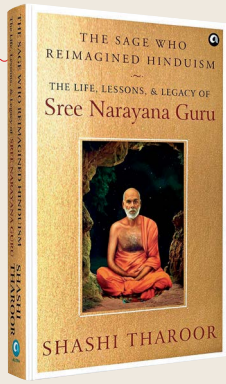
## THE LISTICLE

**RECENT BOOK RELEASES THAT SHOULD BE ON YOUR READING LIST**




**GLORIOUS FAILURE**
The Forgotten History of French Imperialism in India
*By Robert Ivermee*
WESTLAND/ CONTEXT
**₹699; 384 pages**

# Telling Tales



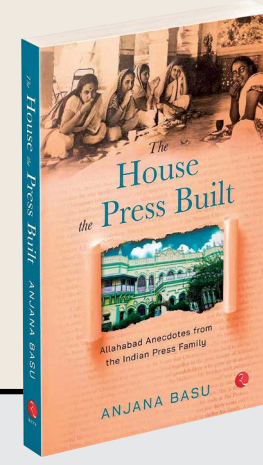

**THE SAGE WHO REIMAGINED HINDUISM**
The Life, Lessons, & Legacy of Sree Narayana Guru
*By Shashi Tharoor*
ALEPH
**₹799; 336 pages**

**The prolific Shashi Tharoor is back with another book,** this time about Sree Narayana Guru, a spiritual leader and social reformer from Kerala, who was born in a village outside Thiruvananthapuram in 1855. Belonging to the ostracised Ezhava community, he went on to have millions of followers and made "one caste, one religion, and one god for all human beings" his rallying cry. His 'Daiva Dasakam', penned around 1914, remains a popular community poem in Kerala to this day.

## FRENCH CONNECTION

The shadow of the British Empire looms so large over the jewel in its crown that we sometimes forget that the French were here too. Their imperial project, of course, bombed badly, and this well-researched book delivers that tale in an engaging and balanced manner.

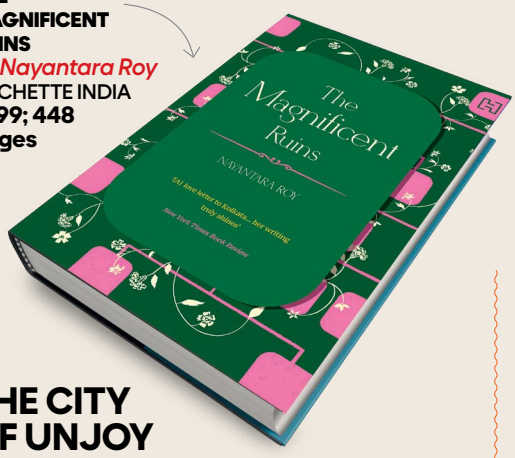
**THE HOUSE THE PRESS BUILT**
Allahabad Anecdotes from the Indian Press Family
*By Anjana Basu*
RUPA
**₹395; 192 pages**




## PAST PERFECT

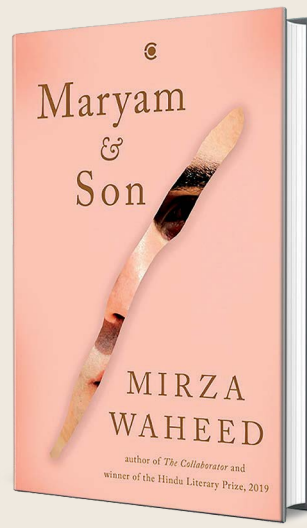
In evocative prose, seasoned writer Anjana Basu pays tribute to Chintamoni Ghosh, her maternal ancestor who founded the Indian Press in Allahabad in 1884 and went on to publish Tagore's *Gitanjali*. But more than about the pioneering press, this is a memoir of the times as viewed from the grand house that Ghosh built and where his family thrived.

**THE MAGNIFICENT RUINS**
*By Nayantara Roy*
HACHETTE INDIA
**₹899; 448 pages**




## THE CITY OF UNJOY

On her birthday in the summer of 2015, Lila De—a books editor in Brooklyn on the verge of professional glory—gets an unexpected call from her mother, whom she hasn't spoken to in fourteen months, only to learn that she has inherited her grandfather's sprawling five-storeyed house in Kolkata. This precipitates her return to the city, which brings in its wake disgruntled relatives entrenched in the family mansion, a first love, and a celebrated author she's handling. Much drama ensues.




## MORAL CONFLICT

Srinagar-born and London-based novelist Mirza Waheed is no stranger to conflict, which is a recurring theme in his novels. *Maryam & Son*, his fourth, is no different. It's the story of widow and school chef Maryam, who finds her son missing one day, only to discover later that he may be far away from London, up to terrible things.

**MARYAM & SON**
*by Mirza Waheed*
WESTLAND/ CONTEXT
**₹699; 264 pages**

*—compiled by* ***Amit Dixit***